

Problem #1: Evolution of Nna

Solution:

The bottom-most form of the phylogenetic tree are the modern scripts. The Bengali glyph seems most similar to the Odiya glyph. Therefore, 18 must be Odiya. Tamil and Malayalam glyphs are similar and have 3 loops; so does the Kannada and Telugu glyphs. (You could also argue that the four South Indian scripts are likely to evolve from a common ancestor, and the same must hold true for the five North Indian scripts). Therefore, 19 and 20 are Tamil and Malayalam (in any order). Gujarati and Hindi glyphs are similar, and should fit in boxes 16 and 17. The remaining one Gurumukhi/Punjabi should then occupy box 15. Then work upward the tree by choosing the forms which is most similar to all its successors. For example, glyph H is most similar to Hindi and Gujarati. Therefore, it is the obvious choice for 12. Similarly, B and E are most similar to Malayalam and Tamil glyphs (3 loops) and are a natural choice for box 14 and its predecessor, 11.

Box Number	Glyph letter (A-N) or Language Name	Box Number	Glyph letter (A-N) or Language Name
1	F	11	B or E
2	I	12	H
3	J	13	N
4	D or M	14	E or B
5	G	15	Punjabi/Gurumukhi
6	M or D	16	Hindi/Devanagari or Gujarati
7	C	17	Gujarati or Hindi/Devanagari
8	K	18	Odiya
9	A	19	Tamil or Malayalam
10	L	20	Malayalam or Tamil
Assignment 2:	<i>Printing Technology</i> In the ancient times, manuscripts were hand-written. Minor changes in the glyph forms introduced during copying accumulated over time and eventually the forms of the glyphs changed significantly leading to different scripts from a single ancestor. However, with the advent of printing technology, glyph forms were copied and transmitted down the generations faithfully. There were no change in the forms thereafter and the natural evolution of scripts stopped.		